An Overview

Unit – 1

The prose section contains a touching narration titled **'Two Gentlemen of Verona'** by **A.J. Cronin**, which describes the responsible and mature behaviour of two young brothers who toil day and night to pay for the treatment of their elder sister, a war victim who suffers from a critical disease. **'The Castle'** by **Edwin Muir** describes the fall of a formidable castle caused by betrayal from within. The supplementary section consists of **Leo Tolstoy's** short story **'God Sees the Truth but Waits'**, which describes the ultimate triumph of truth proving a convict's innocence. It also brings out the magnanimous nature of Aksionov who forgives the actual culprit and breathes his last peacefully.

Grammar : Tenses, Modal auxiliaries, Reported speech
Writing : Letter Writing

Unit – 2

A Nice Cup of Tea is an essay by **George Orwell**. It is a description of the craft of making tea. In the poem **'Our Casuarina Tree'** the poet **Toru Dutt** describes the huge tree in her garden which symbolises her happy childhood associations. **'Life of Pi'** by **Yann Martel** is a 'fantasy' which describes the incredible experience of a young man who survives a dangerous ordeal in the sea. The story was made into a film in the year 2012.

Grammar : Prepositions, Prepositional phrases, Conjunctions and connectives.
Writing : Article Writing, Essay Writing

Unit – 3

'In Celebration of Being Alive' is an extract from a speech of **Dr. Chriistian Barnard**, the first doctor to perform a heart transplant surgery. The doctor recounts an incident involving two critically ill children, whose zest for life made him understand how important it is to celebrate being alive. **William Shakespeare's** poem **'All the World's a Stage',** traces the seven different stages in a man's life with all the characteristics of each stage. **Percival Wilde's** play **'The Hour of Truth'** forms the supplementary section, portraying the integrity of Robert Baldwin and his painful sacrifice of friendship in defence of truth.

Grammar : Active & Passive Voice, Interrogations or Questions
Writing : Story Writing

Unit – 4

'The Summit' is a travelogue – an amazing account of the conquest of Mt. Everest by **Edmund Hillary** and Tenzing Norgay. The poem **'Ulysses'** by **Alfred Tennyson** describes the mythical Greek hero's unquenchable thirst for adventure. **'The Midnight Visitor'** by **Robert Arthur**, is a gripping story of high drama at midnight in which a detective who defies stereotype outwits a hardened criminal with his quick wit and presence of mind.

Grammar : Kinds of Sentences, Conditional Clauses
Writing : Summarizing, Interpreting Non-Verbal Presentations

Unit – 5

'The Chair' is a short story by Ki. Rajanarayanan which narrates the humorous incidents that happen after the arrival of a chair. The poem **'A Father to his Son'** by **Carl August Sandburg** captures a loving father's invaluable advice to his son. **'All Summer in a Day'** by **Ray Bradbury**, a piece of science fiction, explores the theme of life on planet Venus.

Grammar : Non-Finite Verbs, Degrees of Comparison
Writing : Slogan Writing, Paragraph Writing

Unit – 6

'On the Rule of the Road' an essay by **A.G Gardiner**, emphasises the importance of responsible public behaviour respecting the liberty of others and upholding the norms of the society. The poem **'Incident of the French Camp'** by **Robert Browning**, is a heartrending story of a young soldier who sacrifices his life for the sake of his country with great pride and honour. The humorous play **'Remember Caesar'** by **Gordon Daviot** revolves around Lord Weston's mistaken threat to his life.

Grammar : Concord
Writing : Describing a Process

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